

# Ross Dahlke

Assistant Professor

University of Wisconsin-Madison, School of Journalism and Mass Communication

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## Academic Appointments

### University of Wisconsin-Madison

Assistant Professor

- School of Journalism and Mass Communication
- Affiliate, Elections Research Center

Madison, WI

2025-Present

## Education

### Stanford University

PhD: Communication

- Dissertation: The Public Sphere in Private Spaces: Politics, News, and Misinformation in Personal Messaging Applications
- Advisor: Jeffrey T. Hancock, Committee: Jennifer Pan, Byron Reeves, Matthew Gentzkow, Michael Bernstein (chair)
- Data Science Scholar, Stanford Data Science Program
- Knight-Hennessy Scholar

Palo Alto, CA

2022-2024

### Stanford University

MA: Communication

- Knight-Hennessy Scholar

Palo Alto, CA

2020-2022

### University of Wisconsin-Madison

JBA, Comprehensive Honors (Honors in the Liberal Arts and in the Major) Journalism & Mass Communication; Political Science

- Theodore Herfurth Award for top undergraduate male student
- College of Letters & Science Dean's Prize awarded to three students

Madison, WI

2014-2018

## Research

### Publications

\* indicates equal authorship

11. Kim, Y. M., **Dahlke**, R., Song, H., & Heinrich, R. (2026). Targeted digital voter suppression efforts likely decrease voter turnout. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, 123(5), e2519944123. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2519944123>
10. **Dahlke\***, R., Tu\*, F., Wang\*, Y.-C., Lu, Y., Engeda, B. W., & Hancock, J. T. (2025). Contextualizing Misinformation: A User-Centric Approach to Linguistic and Topical Patterns in News Consumption. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction*, 9(CSCW1), 1–40. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3757571>
9. **Dahlke**, R., & Hancock, J. (2025). Untrustworthy website exposure and election beliefs: Selective exposure and ideological asymmetry. *Journal of Online Trust and Safety*, 3(1). <https://doi.org/10.54501/jots.v3i1.250>
8. **Dahlke**, R., Kumar, D., Durumeric, Z., & Hancock, J. T. (2025). Quantifying the Systematic Bias in the Accessibility and Inaccessibility of Web Scraping Content From URL-Logged Web-Browsing Digital Trace Data. *Social Science Computer Review*, 43(5), 1071–1086. <https://doi.org/10.1177/08944393231218214>
7. Lukito, J., Macdonald, M., Chen, B., Brown, M. A., Prochaska, S., Yang, Y., Greenfield, J., Suk, J., Zhong, W., **Dahlke**, R., & Borah, P. (2025). Candidates Be Posting: Multi-Platform Strategies and Partisan Preferences in the 2022 US Midterm Elections. *Social Media+ Society*, 11(2), 20563051251337541. <https://doi.org/10.1177/20563051251337541>
6. **Dahlke**, R., & Pan, J. (2024). January 6 Arrests and Media Coverage Do Not Remobilize Conservatives on Social Media. *Proceedings of the National Academies of Sciences*. <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2401239121>

5. Moore\*, R. C., **Dahlke\***, R., Forberg, P. L., & Hancock, J. T. (2024). The Private Life of QAnon: A Mixed Methods Investigation of Americans' Exposure to QAnon Content on the Web. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction*, 8(CSCW2), 1–34. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3687057>
4. **Dahlke**, R., & Zhang, Y. (2024). Surviving or thriving political defeat on social media: a temporal analysis of how electoral loss exacerbates the gender gap in political expression. *Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication*, 29(1), zmad051. <https://doi.org/10.1093/jcmc/zmad051>
3. Chen, B., Borah, P., **Dahlke**, R., & Lukito, J. (2024). Battle for Inbox and Bucks: Comparing Email Fundraising Strategies of Donald Trump and Joe Biden in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election. *Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*. <https://doi.org/10.51685/jqd.2024.012>
2. Lukito, J., Greenfield, J., Yang, Y., **Dahlke**, R., Brown, M. A., Lewis, R., & Chen, B. (2024). Audio-as-data tools: Replicating computational data processing. *Media and Communication*, 12. <https://doi.org/10.17645/mac.7851>
1. Moore\*, R. C., **Dahlke\***, R., & Hancock, J. T. (2023). Exposure to untrustworthy websites in the 2020 US election. *Nature Human Behaviour*, 1096–1105. <https://doi.org/10.1038/s41562-023-01564-2>

## Papers Under Review

\* indicates equal authorship

8. Lee, A. Y., Stevic, A., Walker-Keleher, G., Chen, C., Charity, E., **Dahlke**, R., & Hancock, J. (2026). Going light: The effects of minimal mobile phone adoption on young adults' well-being depend on motivation. *Forthcoming at CHI: Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*.
7. **Dahlke**, R., Moore, R., Adib-Azpeitia, D., Ugander, J., & Hancock, J. (2026). Multi-Platform Referrers of Misinformation: A Comparative Ablation Study of Misinformation Visits Referred by Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, Reddit, YouTube, Snapchat, and TikTok. *Conditionally Accepted at Political Communication*.
6. **Dahlke\***, R., Moore\*, R., Bengani, P., & Hancock, J. (2026). The Consumption of Pink Slime Journalism: Who, What, When, Where, and Why? *Conditionally Accepted at Digital Journalism*. <https://doi.org/10.31219/osf.io/3bwz6>
5. **Dahlke**, R., Yang, Y., Lukito, J., Greenfield, J., Chen, B., Brown, M. A., & Lewis, R. (2026). Linguistic and Auditory Style on The Alex Jones Show Predicts InfoWars Sales: A Multi-Modal Analysis of a Media Empire. *Revise & Resubmit at Information, Communication & Society*.
4. Lukito, J., Zhang, Y., Pruden, M., Prochaska, S., Chen, B., Zhong, W., Brown, M., **Dahlke**, R., Suk, J., Greenfield, J., & Borah, P. (2026). Cross-Platformization: How U.S. Right-Leaning Media Curate Their Posts on Twitter and Truth Social. *Revise & Resubmit at New Media and Society*.
3. Kwon, H., Jiang, X., & **Dahlke**, R. (2026). Do Politicians' Strategic Facial Expressions Drive Resonant Moments on Social Media? Computational Analysis of the 2024 U.S. Presidential Debate Using Multimodal Large Language Models. *Revise & Resubmit at International Journal of Communication*.
2. **Dahlke\***, R., Moore\*, R. C., & Hancock, J. T. (2026). Exposure to (AI-generated) untrustworthy websites in the 2024 US election. *Under Review at Nature Communications*. [https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/qtdmg\\_v1](https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/qtdmg_v1)
1. **Dahlke**, R., Mine, N., Zhao, H., Huang, Y., & Shah, D. (2026). Electoral Prediction Markets: A Quantitative Description of Online Political Betting Markets. *Letter of Inquiry Under Review at Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media*.

## Public Pre-Prints & Reports

2. **Dahlke**, R., & Hancock, J. (2025). The public sphere in private spaces: Quantifying political computer-mediated communication in personal messaging. *OSF Preprints*. <https://osf.io/6cpv8/>
1. Lukito, J., Brown, M. A., **Dahlke**, R., Suk, J., Yang, Y., Zhang, Y., Chen, B., Kim, S. J., & Soorholtz, K. (2023). The state of digital media data research, 2023. *Social Science Research Council*. <http://dx.doi.org/10.26153/tsw/46177>

## Invited Talks and Guest Lectures

### Exploring Ethical Use of AI and Computational Methods in Organizational Research

Organizational Communication Mini Conference 2025

University of Illinois  
Urbana-Champaign  
10/2025

## Stanford Democracy Day & Stanford Data Science

Understanding Election Manipulation with Data Science

Stanford University

11/2024

## Communication 124/224: Truth, Trust & Technology

Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election

Stanford University

11/2023

## Stanford Democracy Day & Stanford Data Science

Untrustworthy Website Exposure and Effects

Stanford University

11/2023

Single Case Research Methodology and Visualization

University of Minnesota-Twin Cities

09/2023

## Cyber Policy Center, Freeman Spogli Institute

Exposure to Untrustworthy Websites in the 2020 U.S. Presidential Election

Stanford University

05/2022

## Awards

Collaborative Summer Research Initiative (50% Graduate Project Assistantship): University of Wisconsin-Madison

Elections Research Center \$10,700

2025

Top Reviewer Award, 2023: Social Science Computer Review

2024

Non-Western Countries Expanding Online Trust & Safety Research Grant: Stanford Cyber Policy Center \$15,000

2024

Data Science Scholar: Stanford University Data Science \$93,000

2023

Stanford EST (Ethics, Society, and Technology) Research Grant: Stanford University \$5,000

2023

Stanford PACS (Philanthropy and Civil Society) Research Grant: Stanford University \$3,000

2023

Graduate Student Researcher: Office of Army Research & Department of Defense Multidisciplinary University Research

2023

Initiative Grant (MURI): Multi-Modal Network Information Dynamics Group

Knight-Hennessy Scholarship: Stanford University \$280,000

2020

## Teaching

### JOURN 677: Concepts and Tools for Data Analysis and Visualization

Instructor

University of Wisconsin-Madison

01/2026 - 05/2026

### JOURN 818: Computational Approaches for Communication Research

Instructor

University of Wisconsin-Madison

09/2025 - 12/2025

### JOURN 677: Concepts and Tools for Data Analysis and Visualization

Instructor

University of Wisconsin-Madison

09/2025 - 12/2025

### JOURN 677: Concepts and Tools for Data Analysis and Visualization

Instructor

University of Wisconsin-Madison

01/2025 - 05/2025

### Communication 124/224: Truth, Trust & Technology

Teaching Assistant

Stanford University

03/2024 - 06/2024

### Communication 172/272: Media Psychology

Teaching Assistant

Stanford University

01/2023 - 03/2023

### Inter-LS 250: Undergraduate Research Experience

Teaching Fellow

University of Wisconsin-Madison

09/2016 - 05/2018

## Advising

### PhD Advising

Haotian (Barry) Zhao

Yanshu (Sybil) Wang

### Research MA Advising

Yingqi (Vicky) Huang

## Directed Study

Professional Development

|                                                                                                 |                                                      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Center for Teaching, Learning, and Mentoring</b><br>Madison Teaching and Learning Excellence | University of Wisconsin-Madison<br>08/2025 - 05/2026 |
| <b>Wisconsin Center for Education Research</b><br>The Discussion Project                        | University of Wisconsin-Madison<br>08/2025           |
| <b>Office of the Provost</b><br>Wisconsin Idea Seminar                                          | University of Wisconsin-Madison<br>05/2025           |

Service

School of Journalism and Mass Communication Service

|                           |                   |
|---------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Graduate Committee</b> | 01/2025 - Present |
|---------------------------|-------------------|

Disciplinary Service

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>International Journal of Press + Politics</b><br>Data Editor                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | 01/2025 - Present |
| <b>Media &amp; Democracy Data Cooperative (MDDC)</b><br>Research Lead, Executive Board Member, <a href="https://mddatacoop.org/">https://mddatacoop.org/</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | 09/2020 - Present |
| <b>International Communication Association Hackathon</b><br>Co-Organizer, <a href="https://www.hackingcommsci.org/">https://www.hackingcommsci.org/</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | 06/2023 - 06/2024 |
| <b>Digital Data Conference (D2C)</b><br>Co-Organizer, <a href="https://mediaengagement.org/event/digital-data-conference/">https://mediaengagement.org/event/digital-data-conference/</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | 12/2021 - 04/2022 |
| <b>Peer-Reviewer</b><br>AI and Ethics, Communication Methods and Measures, Computational Communication Research, Human Communication Research, Information Processing and Management, International Journal of Public Opinion Research, Journal of Online Trust and Safety, Journal of Quantitative Description: Digital Media, Mass Communication & Society, New Media & Society, Political Communication, Science Advances, Social Science Computer Review, Virtual Reality |                   |

Professional Experience

|                                                   |                              |
|---------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|
| <b>Data Scientist</b><br>Ovative Group            | Minneapolis, MN<br>2018-2020 |
| <b>Political Data Consultant</b><br>Self-Employed | Madison, WI<br>2015-2024     |